



1798

NAPOLEON BONAPARTE INVADES EGYPT

In May 1798, Napoleon sailed for Africa, planning to annex Ottoman Egypt and disrupt British influence in the area. His victory at the Battle of the Pyramids was balanced by defeat at the naval Battle of the Nile (1-2 August). After an unsuccessful expedition in Syria (1799), Napoleon evaded the British at Aboukir Bay and escaped to France (July 1799).

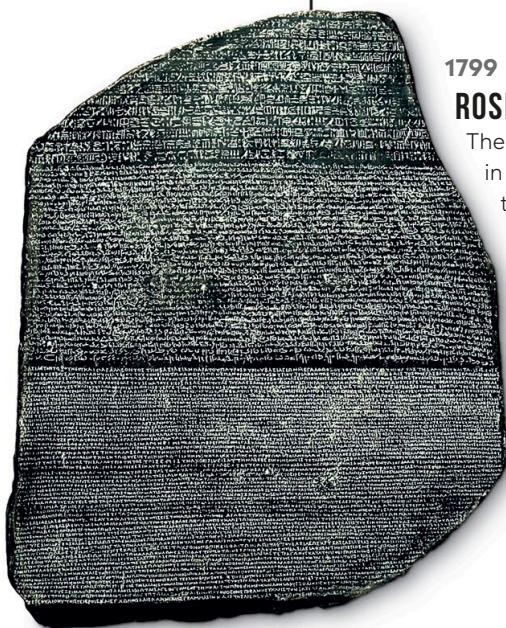
◀ Battle of the Pyramids, 21 July 1798

1799

1799 Napoleon Bonaparte
overthrows the French First
Republic and makes himself
First Consul

**1798 The Society of
United Irishmen** rebel
against British rule, aiming
to form a republic

1799 Tipu Sulta, the “Tiger of
Mysore”, dies defending his stronghold
at Srirangapatna against a British,
Maratha, and Hyderabad force



1799

ROSETTA STONE UNEARTHED

The Rosetta Stone was uncovered by French soldiers in the town of Rashid (Rosetta), Egypt, in 1799, and then captured by the British in 1801. Inscribed with a decree issued in 196 BCE written in three ways – ancient Greek, Egyptian demotic, and hieroglyphics – the stone helped scholars decode ancient Egyptian hieroglyphics.

**Deciphering the Rosetta Stone
took 20 years**

△ The Rosetta Stone, key to hieroglyphics